

and we had a lot of false key presses. Two quick key hits may also be registered as one therefore there is no reward even after you get used to the flawed interface. The menus are well presented but not as intuitive as we would have liked – things aren't always in their logical locations. The screen lock button is slider based and feels clicky. The volume buttons are an exception to the ergonomic misses and although built flush into the phone, they are easy to use owing to great feedback. Since the phone uses SD memory the card bay occupies a lot of space and the multimedia buttons are placed below this slot. Although all the buttons on the sides are easy to use, we lament the lack of backlight that would have made them accessible in low-light conditions. To that end, we have to question Motorola's design sense to make non-backlit buttons that are the same colour, and as flat, as the bezel around them. The earbuds supplied are decent but the size of the bud is huge and not a comfortable fit for most ears. One plus is the provision of a 3.5-mm jack. Music playback is good but the camera is mostly included because not having one would be a glaring omission.

Priced at Rs. 10,078 the ROKR E6 is a handset that



Motorola ROKR E6

has quite a few flaws and might only be attractive to our Tux lovers.

LG KP500 Cookie

When we first saw the Cookie a few months back we thought "neat". Now we realise it's a look and form factor that LG has cashed in on and hopes to milk before the idea of a large

touchscreen stops appealing to users. If skimming the cream was what they had in mind then the name is most apt. It's got undeniable good looks with a slick looking two-tone black body along with a red bezel and highlights. The phone is solid to look and solid in hand.

The large screen is what causes the bulk, but it's not a thick handset. That being said, we feel LG could have pushed in an additional 0.5-inch to its display if they kept the surrounding bezel to a minimum. The screen is clear and the on-screen menus, while not the best, are clear, sharp and very visible. Below the 3-inch LCD display the call buttons sit amidst a chrome trim that looks tasteful – thankfully LG has not overdone the finery. The joypad is a little iffy to use for navigation but the centre button works well.

For such a large display and what is obviously a multimedia phone, the Cookie has a small battery rated at a mere 900 mAh – we would have preferred something in the range of 1200 mAh, since touchscreen devices tend to drain juice faster. The onscreen keypad is a pain to use for messaging and the lack of a hardware keypad doesn't help.

We wish manufacturers would take such things seriously – a large touchscreen is no trade for a usable keypad.

Typing out a message results in frustration, thankfully the number keypad is a little better, but then it's hard to mess up on that front, and we'd have butchered this phone if that were the case. Call quality is good, and the KP500 has a good antenna as well as a decent handsfree unit. It also comes with a few touch-based games that will keep you occupied. The camera is 3.2-

megapixels but nothing special in terms of quality of results. We were surprised at the price tag of Rs. 10,990, despite the nitpicking

it's a good price for a feature-rich device that has nearly everything right, aside from ergonomics. If a large touchscreen is your cup of tea, this is just the cookie for you.



Moto Razr V8

A really appealing phone that will have an equal fan following from both sexes. The RAZR V8 comes in a cool package with a nice soft pouch as an added accessory. Everything is packed neatly and



LG KP500 Cookie

the packing is of good quality. The phone itself has a sleek, sharp look about it and the outer screen is immediately eye catching – it's clear and super crisp. The dark blue-grey colour tone also sets

off the sharp silhouette of the phone. The body is solid metal and of superb quality and the back cover fits beautifully. We were a little disappointed to find a 950 mAh battery, although anything larger and the phone would get bulkier. Since the inner screen is larger and has the same number of pixels, it isn't as sharp as the outer display and the fonts also seem (peculiarly) optimised for the outer screen as they appear a little large with slight, jaggedness around their edges.

The menu system is rather simple and well laid out, very newbie friendly. The keypad is typical Motorola – although its flat key feedback and spacing is great so usability isn't an issue. Some might find the keys a little hard though. Call clarity is good and the phone has a decent loudspeaker that also works well for music.



Motorola RAZR V8

The handsfree unit is decent but you do not get a 3.5-mm jack. The camera is a bit of a letdown at two megapixels and doesn't do much.

Priced at Rs. 11,759 the Motorola RAZR V8 is a little feature shy but it makes up for its shortcomings by being a stunner. If our hearts ruled and we could go back to college with one handset to flick open and flaunt with the hope of attracting every passing lady's attention, this would be the one we'd choose.

LG KM710

A matte-finished rear, akin to the finishes on some of the high-end SLR cameras, a black satin-finished front with a narrow chrome rim around the outer bezel and a huge circular jog-dial of chrome surrounding a brightly lit touch centre button. Sounds crazy? We thought so too – the KM710 looks like a concept phone that went into production. Spin the jog dial and a light will dance around, in tune with the movement. The outer body is built very well and the menu buttons are backlit and touch activated. Use them and you'll get a slight vibration as feedback. The backlight is bright enough to be legible in daylight and everything is properly spaced out. The slider is positive and ultra-slick and looks like it was built to last. The number keypad is similar to the ones Motorola uses – flat, well laid out with good feedback. Typing out messages is a snap. Surprisingly, the call buttons are located alongwith the number keys, inside the slider, and you cannot use the call button unless the keypad is open. The

centre button on the joypad will suffice for making calls but there's no way to cancel a call via a dedicated hardware button; unless the keypad is open. The jog dial is useful for navigating though menus but it's not very accurate and it's easy to scroll past an option, getting just the right amount of turn on the dial requires practice and we weren't able to get the